



Field visit report

Date and Venue	On June 30, 2026 , in collaboration with ICRAF& RWVCA conducted a work visit in Nyanza District at Ultimate Forest Company .
Participants	✓ 18 forest farmers' cooperatives from Rwamagana District, organized under PFMUs through the TREPA project. ✓ Icraf staff (3) ✓ RWVCA Staff (2)
Activities and Demonstrations	• Tree Preparation: Cooperative representative observed how trees are properly prepared. • Timber Processing: Demonstrations on how timber is processed for market readiness. • Pole Manufacturing: Cooperative representative learned how poles are produced and standardized.
Capacity Development Needs Assessment	RWVCA, in collaboration with ICRAF, conducted a Capacity Development Needs Assessment to identify existing gaps and opportunities for strengthening PFMU management and performance. • This assessment provided insights into areas requiring support. • It will guide tailored interventions to improve governance, operational efficiency, and market competitiveness.
Outcomes	• Realization of Exploitation: Leaders acknowledged they had been exploited in past sales due to poor preparation of trees. • Commitment to Change: They resolved to prepare trees properly to produce timber and poles. • Market Opportunity: Proper preparation ensures access to ready markets, yielding higher profits compared to previous practices. • Association Membership: Cooperative representatives were informed about the benefits of joining RWVCA and unanimously agreed to register.



RWANDA WOOD VALUE CHAIN ASSOCIATION



Contribution of Ultimate Forest Company	During the field visit, Ultimate Forest Company made several important commitments to support the participating forest farmers' cooperatives from Rwamagana District. • Provision of Free Tree Seedlings: Ultimate pledged to provide free tree seedlings to the participating cooperatives to support afforestation and improve forest productivity. • Support in Pest Management: Ultimate committed to helping cooperatives access environmentally friendly pesticides to control termites and other pests that attack young trees. • Market Linkage for Forest Products: Ultimate assured the cooperatives that it would provide a reliable market for their timber. Representatives were advised not to harvest their trees prematurely. Instead, they were encouraged to allow the trees to mature so they could be processed into utility poles, • Technical Knowledge Transfer: Through practical demonstrations, Ultimate Forest Company trained cooperative representatives on proper tree preparation, timber processing, and pole production.
PFMU representatives recommendation	Member Sensitization: PFMU representatives requested ICRAF to organize a meeting for cooperative committees, where RWVCA would explain the benefits of joining. • They emphasized that once all members understand equally, they will register immediately since registration fees are already available.

Done at Kigali on, 30/06/2026

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